

YUJIN ZHANG

Contact Information

Department of Political Science
Columbia University
420 W. 118th Street
New York, NY, 10027

@ yz3658@columbia.edu
Website: yujinzhang.com

Education

Columbia University in the City of New York, New York, NY

2027 (Expected)

Ph.D., Political Science

– Fields: International Relations (Major), Comparative Politics

– Dissertation: Early-Life Experiences and Global Public Opinion on Economic Policymaking

– Dissertation Committee: Allison Carnegie (Co-Chair), Nikhar Gaikwad (Co-Chair), Junyan Jiang, Calvin Thrall

M.Phil., Political Science

2022

M.A., Political Science

2020

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University, Washington, D.C.

2018

M.A., International Political Economy and International Economics

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO

2016

B.A., magna cum laude, Business Administration

Hunan University, Changsha, Hunan, China

2014

B.A., Finance

Research Interests

Research Focus: International political economy, transformation of the international economic order, economic security and statecraft, political socialization

Regional Focus: East Asia, Developed Economies

Publications

[2] **Zhang, Yujin.** 2026. "Inflation of Populism: Effects of Early Economic Experiences on Support for Populist Parties." *Economics & Politics*, Early View.

– Keywords: Inflation, Populism, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, European Politics

[1] Ji, Chengyuan, Junyan Jiang, and **Yujin Zhang**. 2024. “Political Trust and Government Performance in the Time of COVID-19.” *World Development* 176 (106499).

– Keywords: Health governance, political trust

Revise &
Resubmit

[2] **Zhang, Yujin.** "Assistance to Me, and to Thee: Early Inequality Experiences and Public Preferences for Overseas Aid." *Revise and Resubmit at International Studies Quarterly*. [Link](#).

– Keywords: Foreign Aid, Inequality, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, Developed Countries

[1] **Zhang, Yujin.** “Prosperity and Openness: Early Globalization Experiences and Mass Preferences for Free Trade.” *Revise and Resubmit at Comparative Political Studies*. (Job Market Paper). [Link](#).

– Keywords: Trade preferences, Formative Experiences, Public Opinion, East and South-east Asia

- Presentations: APSA 2024, MPSA 2024

	SAIS, Johns Hopkins University	
	Prof. Ling Chen	2017-19
	Prof. David Steinberg	2018-19
Fellowships, Grants, and Awards	External	
	Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies (\$6,500)	2024, 26
	Finalist, NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars	2024, 26
	Expense Support Grant, Institute for Humane Studies (\$7,500)	2025
	Travel Grant, Graduate Students in International Political Economy	2022
	Travel Grant, International Studies Association	2019
	Columbia University	
	C. Martin Wilbur Fellowship	2025-26
	CPE Graduate Student Grant (\$7,000)	2025-26
	Dissertation Fellowship	2023-24
	Travel Grant	2023-26
	Teaching Fellowship	2020-23, 24
	Weatherhead East Asian Institute Fellowship	2019-20
	SAIS, Johns Hopkins University	
	SAIS Fellowship	2017-18
Conferences & Workshops	2026: APSA $c,d \times 3, p \times 2$ $\diamond$ GSIPE-APSA Pre-Conference Workshop $\diamond$ ISA $c, p \times 2$ $\diamond$ IHS Trade Workshop 2025: IPES $p \times 2$ $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ MPSA d, p 2024: Virtual International Political Economy Society $\diamond$ NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars $\diamond$ GSIPE Mini-Conference $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ APSA $\diamond$ MPSA 2023: Northeast Regional Workshop in European Politics $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ APSA 2022: GSIPE APSA Workshop 2021: Political Science Speaker Series 2019: ISA	
	<i>*c = Chair, d = Discussant, p = Paper</i>	
Skills	Languages: Mandarin (Native) Programming: R, Stata, L ^A T _E X, Python, LLM API integration Methods: Survey design, experiment design, conjoint analysis	
Service	Event Coordinator, Graduate Students in International Political Economy	2024-25
Referee	<i>Policy Studies Social Science Research World Development</i>	
Professional Experience	The US-China Business Council	2018-19
	China Africa Research Initiative	2016-17, 2018-19
	The Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars	2018
	The Brookings Institution	2018

References

Allison Carnegie

Department of Political Science
Columbia University
1331 International Affairs
420 W. 118th Street
New York, NY 10027
allison.carnegie@columbia.edu

Junyan Jiang

Department of Political Science
Columbia University
917 International Affairs
420 W. 118th Street
New York, NY 10027
jj3160@columbia.edu

Nikhar Gaikwad

Department of Political Science
Columbia University
739 International Affairs
420 W. 118th Street
New York, NY 10027
nikhar.gaikwad@columbia.edu

Calvin Thrall

Department of Political Science
Columbia University
734 International Affairs
420 W. 118th Street
New York, NY 10027
ct3168@columbia.edu